NFL League Superlatives

Week 2026. Best and worst team in every category, grouped by where it lives on the sheets. Top 3 and bottom 3 shown, with the #1 team's supporting numbers. Built from this season's real team data, 32 teams, about 4 games played each.

POWER INDEX

Power Index (Total: Offense + Defense)

Sum of the project's weighted offense and defense power ratings (z-score blends of points, yards/play, EPA, success rate, turnovers, red zone). Higher = better.

BEST	WORST
1. SF +2.51 Off +1.91 · Def +0.60 · VOID +0.181	**1. MIA** -2.03 Off -1.34 · Def -0.69 · VOID -0.161
2. KC +1.98	**2. NO** -1.48
3. SEA +1.92	**3. IND** -1.25

Offensive Power Index

Offense-only rating from the same weighted blend.

BEST	WORST
1. SF +1.91 PPG 30.5 · YPP 7.03 · EPA/play +0.291	**1. MIA** -1.34 PPG 11.5 · YPP 5.10 · EPA/play -0.141
2. BAL +1.44	**2. TB** -1.14
3. KC +1.26	**3. LAC** -1.07

Defensive Power Index

Defense-only rating; sign-flipped so higher is always better.

BEST	WORST
1. MIN +1.86 PA/G 12.8 · YPP allowed 4.88 · EPA/play allowed -0.184	**1. DAL** -1.57 PA/G 28.0 · YPP allowed 6.51 · EPA/play allowed +0.201
2. SEA +1.55	**2. NO** -1.41
3. LA +1.08	**3. DET** -1.36

OVERALL OFFENSE & DEFENSE

Offense

Ranked by offensive EPA per play, the project's strongest single quality stat.

BEST	WORST
1. SF +0.291 EPA/play PPG 30.5 · YPP 7.03 · Success 54.5%	**1. LAC** -0.159 EPA/play PPG 16.8 · YPP 5.01 · Success 40.4%
2. BUF +0.191 EPA/play	**2. TB** -0.154 EPA/play
3. BAL +0.186 EPA/play	**3. MIA** -0.141 EPA/play

Defense

Ranked by defensive EPA per play allowed. Lower = better.

BEST	WORST
1. MIN -0.184 EPA/play allowed	**1. DAL** +0.201 EPA/play allowed
PA/G 12.8 · YPP allowed 4.88 · Success allowed 32.9%	PA/G 28.0 · YPP allowed 6.51 · Success allowed 52.5%
2. SEA -0.137 EPA/play allowed	**2. DET** +0.183 EPA/play allowed
3. LA -0.122 EPA/play allowed	**3. NO** +0.146 EPA/play allowed

THE DAWGS / THE POUND: RUN GAME

Rushing Offense

Ranked by rush EPA per play.

BEST	WORST
1. BUF +0.170 EPA/rush	**1. GB** -0.366 EPA/rush
Yds/carry 5.34 · RYOE +1.55 · Yds/G 140	Yds/carry 3.49 · RYOE -0.88 · Yds/G 61
2. KC +0.148 EPA/rush	**2. LV** -0.206 EPA/rush
3. IND +0.117 EPA/rush	**3. NYJ** -0.166 EPA/rush

Rushing Defense

Ranked by rush EPA allowed per play. Lower = better.

BEST	WORST
1. ATL -0.234 EPA/rush allowed	**1. DEN** +0.138 EPA/rush allowed
Yds/carry allowed 2.99 · Run stop 67.2% · Yds/G allowed 50	Yds/carry allowed 5.02 · Run stop 56.5% · Yds/G allowed 144
2. ARI -0.196 EPA/rush allowed	**2. NO** +0.106 EPA/rush allowed
3. TB -0.171 EPA/rush allowed	**3. DET** +0.066 EPA/rush allowed

Yards Before Contact (proxy: Line Yards)

True YBC is not tracked in this project. Adjusted Line Yards is the closest stat: it credits the offensive line for the early part of each run.

BEST	WORST
1. LA 3.59 line yds/carry	**1. LV** 2.33 line yds/carry
Yds/carry 5.12 · Stuff rate 9.0% · Run success 47.0%	Yds/carry 3.45 · Stuff rate 26.1% · Run success 32.4%
2. ATL 3.44 line yds/carry	**2. GB** 2.33 line yds/carry
3. BUF 3.24 line yds/carry	**3. NE** 2.37 line yds/carry

THE FREEBIRDS / THE DIRTY BIRD: PASS GAME

Passing Offense

Ranked by passing yards per play.

BEST	WORST
1. SF 8.99 yds/pass play	**1. TB** 4.85 yds/pass play
CPOE +4.9 · Rating 127.3 · Pass Yds/G 252	CPOE +1.8 · Rating 61.6 · Pass Yds/G 172
2. BAL 8.78 yds/pass play	**2. ARI** 4.92 yds/pass play
3. SEA 7.65 yds/pass play	**3. IND** 4.99 yds/pass play

Passing Defense

Ranked by passing yards allowed per play. Lower = better.

BEST	WORST
1. SEA 4.29 yds/pass play allowed Comp% allowed 57.8% · Pass Yds/G allowed 145 · INT/G 1.50	**1. DAL** 8.18 yds/pass play allowed Comp% allowed 70.1% · Pass Yds/G allowed 239 · INT/G 0.00
2. LA 4.31 yds/pass play allowed	**2. ARI** 7.92 yds/pass play allowed
3. MIN 5.34 yds/pass play allowed	**3. MIA** 7.74 yds/pass play allowed

Yards After Catch (YAC)

Play-by-play YAC per reception, the same source as the delta sheet.

BEST	WORST
1. ATL 8.14 YAC/rec Yds/completion 11.4 · Separation 3.38 yds · Catch% 67.7%	**1. NYG** 3.33 YAC/rec Yds/completion 10.0 · Separation 2.75 yds · Catch% 62.2%
2. KC 7.72 YAC/rec	**2. ARI** 3.40 YAC/rec
3. MIA 6.45 YAC/rec	**3. PHI** 3.41 YAC/rec

PASS RUSH & SECONDARY

Edge Rushers

Edge pressure rate generated by the defense.

BEST	WORST
1. LA 0.079 edge pressure rate Pressure forced 18.2% · Sacks 7 · Sack% 4.9%	**1. MIA** 0.033 edge pressure rate Pressure forced 17.4% · Sacks 4 · Sack% 3.3%
2. GB 0.078 edge pressure rate	**2. CLE** 0.037 edge pressure rate
3. DEN 0.066 edge pressure rate	**3. DET** 0.038 edge pressure rate

Up-the-Middle Pressure (Tug o' War)

Interior pressure rate generated by the defense (DT/guard-center battle).

BEST	WORST
1. KC 0.058 interior pressure rate Pressure forced 15.4% · Sacks 4 · TFL 12	**1. BUF** 0.019 interior pressure rate Pressure forced 25.0% · Sacks 10 · TFL 9
2. SEA 0.050 interior pressure rate	**2. ARI** 0.021 interior pressure rate
3. DAL 0.049 interior pressure rate	**3. CAR** 0.026 interior pressure rate

Sacks: Pass Rush (getting to the QB)

Defense sack % of dropbacks. Best = most sacks per dropback, worst = can't finish the rush.

BEST	WORST
1. MIN 9.9% sack rate Sacks 16 · Pressure forced 32.5% · Edge 0.049	**1. NYG** 2.1% sack rate Sacks 3 · Pressure forced 11.3% · Edge 0.054
2. CHI 8.4% sack rate	**2. KC** 2.6% sack rate
3. CIN 8.4% sack rate	**3. PHI** 2.7% sack rate

Sacks: Protection (keeping the QB clean)

Offense sack % taken. Lower = better protection; the worst side is the team giving up the most sacks.

BEST	WORST
1. SF 0.0% sacked Sacks allowed 0 · Pressure allowed 9.7% · PBE 92.7	**1. TB** 10.1% sacked Sacks allowed 16 · Pressure allowed 27.2% · PBE 77.1
2. LV 3.2% sacked	**2. MIN** 9.5% sacked
3. WAS 3.4% sacked	**3. MIA** 8.8% sacked

Defensive Backs

Secondary Lock Index, the project's blended coverage grade.

BEST	WORST
1. SEA 95.71 Lock Index Catch% allowed 66.1% · Yds/pass allowed 4.29 · Sep. allowed 3.34 yds	**1. DAL** 91.82 Lock Index Catch% allowed 75.2% · Yds/pass allowed 8.18 · Sep. allowed 3.16 yds
2. LA 95.69 Lock Index	**2. ARI** 92.08 Lock Index
3. MIN 94.66 Lock Index	**3. MIA** 92.26 Lock Index

MATCHUP LEAKS: TIGHT ENDS & MOBILE QBs

Tight Ends: Fantasy Points Allowed

Yardage allowed to TEs is not tracked in this project; PPR fantasy points allowed to the position is the closest stat. Best = stingiest vs TEs, worst = gives up the most.

BEST	WORST
1. NE 5.9 PPR pts/G to TEs Pass Yds/G allowed 190 · Comp% allowed 61.2% · Sep. allowed 2.98 yds	**1. DET** 28.4 PPR pts/G to TEs Pass Yds/G allowed 304 · Comp% allowed 63.2% · Sep. allowed 3.25 yds
2. LA 6.6 PPR pts/G to TEs	**2. KC** 22.6 PPR pts/G to TEs
3. CHI 6.7 PPR pts/G to TEs	**3. ARI** 18.6 PPR pts/G to TEs

Covering Mobile QBs

Not tracked directly. Built from game logs: each defense's EPA/play allowed ONLY in games vs a team the matrix tags as a Mobile QB. Just 1-3 games per team, and 5 teams have not faced one yet, so treat as directional.

BEST	WORST
1. CHI -0.304 EPA/play allowed Games 1 · Pts allowed 7.0 · Pass Yds allowed 141	**1. MIA** +0.460 EPA/play allowed Games 1 · Pts allowed 35.0 · Pass Yds allowed 287
2. MIN -0.225 EPA/play allowed	**2. NYG** +0.221 EPA/play allowed
3. JAX -0.219 EPA/play allowed	**3. DAL** +0.202 EPA/play allowed

RED ZONE

Red Zone Offense

Red zone scoring efficiency. Only ~3 games of trips so far, so small samples swing this hard.

BEST	WORST
1. SF 88.9% efficiency PPG 30.5 · PPD 2.95	**1. MIA** 40.0% efficiency PPG 11.5 · PPD 0.76
2. JAX 85.7% efficiency	**2. TB** 46.2% efficiency
3. ATL 84.6% efficiency	**3. GB** 47.1% efficiency

Red Zone Defense (bonus)

Red zone efficiency allowed. Lower = better. Same small-sample warning.

BEST	WORST
1. MIN 28.6% allowed PA/G 12.8 · PPD allowed 0.61	**1. WAS** 82.4% allowed PA/G 30.5 · PPD allowed 2.13
2. JAX 31.2% allowed	**2. GB** 81.2% allowed
3. CIN 43.8% allowed	**3. DET** 81.0% allowed

WEEK 2026 GAMES BETWEEN HEADLINE TEAMS: PLAYER PREDICTIONS

6 of the 16 Week 2026 games have two teams that each hold a #1 best or worst spot in a category above. Projections for each follow, one page per game.

DAL at DEN

Why it made the list (each is a #1 best or worst team in): **DAL**: worst Defensive Power Index, worst Defense, worst Passing Defense, worst Defensive Backs; **DEN**: worst Rushing Defense

DAL 13 - DEN 22

Model projected score DAL 13.3, DEN 21.9 · total 35.2 · DEN favored by 8.6 · DAL win prob 26%

DAL offense vs DEN defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Dak Prescott	294	1.1	16	0.67 (49%)	2.1

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Javonte Williams	14	59	4.2	21	32%
Tyler Goodson	4	18	0.6	-3	10%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
CeeDee Lamb	12.7	10.1	137	29%
George Pickens	7.7	5.0	62	19%
Ryan Flournoy	6.4	3.5	29	16%

DEN offense vs DAL defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Bo Nix	211	1.8	6	0.54 (42%)	1.3

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
J.K. Dobbins	13	52	0.7	4	35%
Jonah Coleman	6	25	1.4	10	21%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Jaylen Waddle	5.9	3.6	48	27%
Courtland Sutton	5.0	2.0	22	23%
Pat Bryant	2.7	2.0	34	13%

Q = listed Questionable. * = low-confidence baseline. Individual pass rushers and defensive backs are not in the player data, so sacks and interceptions are projected per quarterback from both teams' sack and takeaway rates, not by defender.

DET at GB

Why it made the list (each is a #1 best or worst team in): **DET**: worst Tight Ends: Fantasy Points Allowed; **GB**: worst Rushing Offense

DET 21 - GB 18

Model projected score DET 21.2, GB 17.6 · total 38.8 · DET favored by 3.6 · DET win prob 61%

DET offense vs GB defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Jared Goff	279	1.8	4	0.61 (45%)	2.4

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Jahmyr Gibbs	21	92	5.3	43	59%
Sione Vaki	2	10	1.0	12	11%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Amon-Ra St. Brown	11.0	7.5	70	40%
Jameson Williams	5.9	3.8	53	24%
Isaac TeSlaa	4.0	2.1	43	17%

GB offense vs DET defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Jordan Love	279	1.5	-2	0.67 (49%)	2.6

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
MarShawn Lloyd	7	26	2.3	13	28%
Kaleb Johnson	5	21	0.2	3	17%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Matthew Golden	9.6	4.7	74	28%
Christian Watson	8.3	5.2	89	25%
Skyy Moore	3.3	1.6	9	11%

Q = listed Questionable. * = low-confidence baseline. Individual pass rushers and defensive backs are not in the player data, so sacks and interceptions are projected per quarterback from both teams' sack and takeaway rates, not by defender.

LA at LAC

Why it made the list (each is a #1 best or worst team in): **LA**: best Yards Before Contact, best Edge Rushers; **LAC**: worst Offense

LA 12 - LAC 15

Model projected score LA 11.8, LAC 14.8 · total 26.6 · LAC favored by 3.0 · LA win prob 41%

LA offense vs LAC defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Matthew Stafford	320	0.9	5	0.98 (62%)	2.4

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Kyren Williams	13	64	5.4	51	29%
Blake Corum	8	36	1.0	6	15%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Davante Adams	10.7	6.2	114	18%
Puka Nacua	11.8	7.9	117	19%
Konata Mumpfield	3.9	1.7	33	7%

• OUT: Terrance Ferguson (TE). Their targets are spread to the rest of the group (x1.09).

LAC offense vs LA defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Justin Herbert	165	1.0	22	0.92 (60%)	2.0

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Omarion Hampton	15	60	1.0	7	37%
Keaton Mitchell	7	30	2.1	8	24%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Tre Harris	5.8	3.6	49	16%
Quentin Johnston	5.3	2.0	25	15%
Ladd McConkey (Q)	4.7	3.3	43	14%

• OUT: Charlie Kolar (TE), Brenen Thompson (WR). Their targets are spread to the rest of the group (x1.15).

Q = listed Questionable. * = low-confidence baseline. Individual pass rushers and defensive backs are not in the player data, so sacks and interceptions are projected per quarterback from both teams' sack and takeaway rates, not by defender.

LV at MIA

Why it made the list (each is a #1 best or worst team in): **LV**: worst Yards Before Contact; **MIA**: worst Power Index, worst Offensive Power Index, worst Edge Rushers, worst Covering Mobile QBs

LV 21 - MIA 8

Model projected score LV 21.3, MIA 7.8 · total 29.1 · LV favored by 13.4 · LV win prob 84%

LV offense vs MIA defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Kirk Cousins	257	1.8	-0	0.79 (55%)	1.3

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Ashton Jeanty	21	75	4.3	41	53%
Mike Washington Jr.	7	29	0.2	-0	17%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Tre Tucker	5.2	3.4	58	21%
Jalen Nailor	3.3	1.5	17	14%
Cody White	2.2	1.1	16	10%

MIA offense vs LV defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Malik Willis	188	0.5	28	0.73 (52%)	2.4

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
De'Von Achane	10	45	2.5	20	22%
Ollie Gordon II	9	45	1.9	6	16%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Malik Washington	9.1	5.4	68	13%
Chris Bell	4.1	1.6	29	6%
Kevin Coleman Jr.	4.3	0.9	2	6%

• OUT: Caleb Douglas (WR). Their targets are spread to the rest of the group (x1.18).

Q = listed Questionable. * = low-confidence baseline. Individual pass rushers and defensive backs are not in the player data, so sacks and interceptions are projected per quarterback from both teams' sack and takeaway rates, not by defender.

MIN at NE

Why it made the list (each is a #1 best or worst team in): **MIN**: best Defensive Power Index, best Defense, best Sacks: Pass Rush, best Red Zone Defense; **NE**: best Tight Ends: Fantasy Points Allowed

MIN 3 - NE 16

Model projected score MIN 3.0, NE 15.6 · total 18.6 · NE favored by 12.6 · MIN win prob 16%

MIN offense vs NE defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Carson Wentz	144	0.2	2	0.67 (49%)	2.4

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Aaron Jones	16	69	2.4	22	10%
Jordan Mason	14	57	0.0	0	6%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Jordan Addison	7.5	3.8	53	5%
Jauan Jennings	1.8	1.0	4	1%
Myles Price	1.1	0.7	2	1%

• OUT: Justin Jefferson (WR). Their targets are spread to the rest of the group (x1.25).

NE offense vs MIN defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Drake Maye	177	1.1	34	1.04 (65%)	2.3

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
TreVeyon Henderson	14	54	0.3	2	28%
Rhamondre Stevenson	12	47	2.7	19	32%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Romeo Doubs	4.5	2.7	42	14%
Mack Hollins	4.5	3.4	43	14%
DeMario Douglas	3.8	2.0	17	12%

Q = listed Questionable. * = low-confidence baseline. Individual pass rushers and defensive backs are not in the player data, so sacks and interceptions are projected per quarterback from both teams' sack and takeaway rates, not by defender.

SF at TB

Why it made the list (each is a #1 best or worst team in): **SF**: best Power Index, best Offensive Power Index, best Offense, best Passing Offense; **TB**: worst Passing Offense, worst Sacks: Protection

SF 18 - TB 14

Model projected score SF 18.3, TB 13.7 · total 32.0 · SF favored by 4.6 · SF win prob 64%

SF offense vs TB defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Brock Purdy	237	1.3	30	0.61 (45%)	0.8

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Christian McCaffrey	13	52	3.8	29	47%
Kaelon Black	8	31	0.2	1	23%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Mike Evans (Q)	5.7	4.0	50	24%
Deebo Samuel Sr.	4.0	3.3	44	17%
Demarcus Robinson	2.8	2.4	40	13%

TB offense vs SF defense

QB	Pass yds	Pass TD	Rush yds	INT exp (P≥1)	Sacks taken
Backup (starter Baker Mayfield OUT) *	182	1.0	8	0.88 (58%)	2.5

RB	Carries	Rush yds	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Bucky Irving	13	53	3.4	15	41%
Kenny Gainwell	3	10	2.1	11	17%

WR	Targets	Rec	Rec yds	Anytime TD
Emeka Egbuka	6.3	4.0	38	17%
Chris Godwin Jr.	4.7	4.2	35	13%
Ted Hurst III	4.2	2.1	32	11%

• Baker Mayfield is listed OUT. The only other QB on the roster has no passing sample, so this line is a league-average-starter baseline cut 15% and is low confidence.

Q = listed Questionable. * = low-confidence baseline. Individual pass rushers and defensive backs are not in the player data, so sacks and interceptions are projected per quarterback from both teams' sack and takeaway rates, not by defender.

NOT RANKED: DATA NOT IN THE PROJECT YET

Passing yards allowed at 0-5 and 10-20 yards: the project does not store pass depth (air yards / pass length) per defense, so these are not ranked without inventing numbers. Adding them means pulling air_yards from the play-by-play in nfl_data_pull.py and bucketing by depth.

3RD DOWN SUCCESS: HELD BACK

Best/worst 3rd-down offense and defense are not ranked here on purpose. The 3rd-down % in nfl_team_matrix.csv currently looks wrong (values run about 5% to 11%, while real NFL 3rd-down rates sit near 30% to 50%): the conversion flag is divided by every play, not just 3rd-down attempts. This report turns the 3rd-down cards on automatically once the matrix values look like real percentages. The fix is in nfl_data_pull.py (restrict to down == 3 before the average).